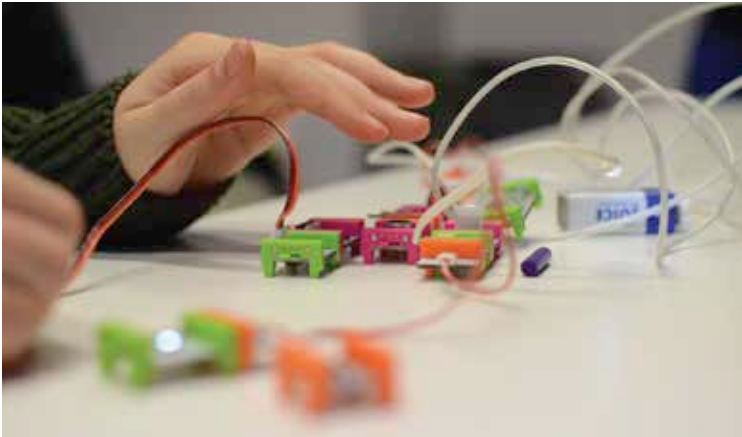


## Who is a maker?

If we broaden our view somewhat, a maker is a DIY-enthusiast. In fact, as we have seen, the entire Maker culture is broadly defined as the technological offspring of the DIY movement. So it is not entirely wrong to assume that what makes a DIY hobbyist and a Maker are but one and same in principle – using cheap and easy to access materials, or reusing existing, out of use, out of order things, working without extensive infrastructure, with the resources and ideas of an entire community at their disposal. The boundaries between the two are not entirely clear, but what does differentiate being a maker from being a DIY enthusiast is the use of technology. Now, when we think of technology, we assume gadgets, electronics, mesh of circuit boards and wires and the rest of the tech mish-mash that usually scares people away with its complexity. But the technology that a maker deals with is



The idea of a maker is a result of the rising DIY culture

simplified, easy to use technology. To some of us, it might not appear to be technology at all. Take the grassroots example of M.R. Prajapati, famous rural innovator and maker from India.

Hailing from a family of clay craftsmen, it is quite natural that he chose clay as his medium of making. Post the earthquakes in Gujarat, he made a refrigerator that keeps food fresh and cool without electricity. In a country like ours, where many villages are yet to be electrified, the impact of this towards avoiding food wastage is enormous. The material he used was clay, widely available and used in rural India. The methods he used were far